

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

PORN HAS HELD ME FROM YOU, GOD

Create in me a clean heart,
O God, and renew a right
right spirit within me.

– PSALM 51:10



Overcomers
Global Network

EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to the one living in silence — the believer who loves God and hates the chain at the same time. You worship on Sunday and fall on Monday, and the shame of that cycle has made you feel disqualified from God's presence. You are not disqualified. You are exactly the kind of person Jesus came for. And today, the chain breaks.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

This is one of the hardest topics in the body of Christ — and it is one of the most necessary. Pornography has infiltrated homes, marriages, ministries, and the private lives of believers who genuinely love God but feel trapped in a cycle they cannot escape.

I am not writing this booklet to condemn you. Condemnation is the enemy's tool, not God's. I am writing to bring truth, understanding, and the power of Christ into a place that has been covered in shame for far too long.

If you are struggling with this, I need you to know: you are not alone. You are not the only believer fighting this battle. And you are not beyond the reach of God's delivering power. Read with an open heart. Freedom is closer than you think.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

You never planned for it to get this far. It started with a glance — a moment of curiosity, a click that seemed harmless. But that one click became a second, and the second became a habit, and the habit became a chain, and now the chain has wrapped itself around your mind so tightly that you cannot separate who you are from what you do in secret.

You know it's wrong. You don't need anyone to tell you that. The guilt is so intense that after every fall, you feel physically sick — like your spirit is retching. You make promises to God: "Never again, Lord. I'm done." And you mean it. Every single time, you mean it. But then the trigger comes — the stress, the loneliness, the boredom, the emotional pain — and the cycle starts over.

And the worst part is not the act itself. The worst part is what comes after: the shame that makes you avoid God. The guilt that steals your worship. The hypocrisy you feel sitting in church knowing what you did the night before. The distance that grows between you and your spouse, your children, your calling. The terrifying thought that maybe God has given up on you — that you've crossed a line and His grace has run out.

You feel like two people: the one who loves God and the one who is enslaved. And the war between them is tearing you apart.

I hear you. And God hears you. And this is not where your story ends.

""O wretched man that I am! Who will deliver me from this body of death? I thank God — through Jesus Christ our Lord!""

— Romans 7:24–25 (NKJV)

What the Bible Says

Let me say something that might surprise you: the Bible does not address pornography with condemnation. It addresses it with compassion, truth, and a path to freedom.

Jesus understood lust. Not because He experienced it — He was sinless — but because He watched it destroy the people He came to save. And He addressed it directly:

""But I say to you that whoever looks at a woman to lust for her has already committed adultery with her in his heart.""

— **Matthew 5:28 (NKJV)**

Some people read this verse and feel more condemned. But Jesus was not trying to crush you — He was trying to show you the root. The problem is not just the behavior. The problem is the heart. And when you deal with the heart, the behavior follows.

The enemy uses pornography as a counterfeit for real intimacy. Every human being was created with a deep need for connection, love, vulnerability, and closeness — with God and with other people. When those needs go unmet — through loneliness, emotional rejection, a loveless marriage, or spiritual dryness — the enemy offers a substitute. Pornography promises connection without risk, pleasure without vulnerability, intimacy without covenant. But it delivers the exact opposite: deeper isolation, deeper shame, and deeper disconnection from the very relationships your soul is starving for.

""The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.""

— **John 10:10 (NKJV)**

Pornography is a thief. It steals your peace, kills your intimacy, and destroys your relationships. But Jesus came to give you abundant life — and that includes sexual wholeness.

The Root of the Pain

The Neuroscience of Pornography Addiction. This is important for you to understand because knowledge removes shame. Pornography addiction is not simply a matter of weak willpower. It is a neurological process that hijacks the brain's reward system.

When a person views pornography, the brain releases a flood of dopamine — the same neurotransmitter involved in drug addiction. Over time, the brain builds a tolerance, requiring more frequent or more extreme content to achieve the same effect. Neural pathways are literally carved into the brain through repetition, creating an automatic response loop: trigger → craving → behavior → temporary relief → shame → trigger.

This is why "just stop" doesn't work. You are fighting a neurological pattern that has been reinforced every single time the behavior occurred. This does not excuse the sin, but it explains why the struggle feels so overwhelming — and why deliverance requires more than willpower. It requires the supernatural power of God working in tandem with practical, consistent steps toward freedom.

Emotional Roots. For many people, pornography is not primarily about sex. It is about self-medication. The same way an alcoholic uses drinking to numb pain, many people use pornography to escape from emotional distress — loneliness, rejection, stress, boredom, anxiety, depression, or unresolved trauma.

If you examine the moments when you are most vulnerable to falling, you will almost always find an emotional trigger underneath. Understanding that trigger is critical because until you deal with the root, you will keep fighting the fruit.

Effects on Relationships. Research consistently shows that pornography use erodes trust in intimate relationships, reduces emotional and physical satisfaction with a real partner, increases feelings of insecurity and inadequacy in spouses, and creates a false and distorted expectation of intimacy. It builds walls between you and the people who love you — even if they don't know what you're doing. They feel the distance. They sense the withdrawal. And the secrecy itself becomes a second sin.

Spiritual Bondage. Beyond the psychological and relational effects, there is a very real spiritual dimension to pornography. The spirit of lust is not just a metaphor — it is a demonic assignment designed to sever your fellowship with God and disqualify you from your calling.

Every time you engage with pornographic material, you are opening a spiritual door. You are inviting images, spirits, and influences into your mind that were never meant to be there. And those influences don't leave when you close the browser. They linger — in your dreams, in your thought patterns, in the way you see people, in the heaviness you feel during prayer.

""Flee sexual immorality. Every sin that a man does is outside the body, but he who commits sexual immorality sins against his own body. Or do you not know that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have from God, and you are not your own?""

— 1 Corinthians 6:18–19 (NKJV)

Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit. That means this struggle is not just personal — it is sacred. And the good news is that the same Holy Spirit who dwells in you has the power to cleanse the temple, reset the patterns, and restore your purity.

Christ's Healing Power

I want you to look at the woman caught in adultery in John chapter 8. The religious leaders dragged her into the public square, threw her at the feet of Jesus, and demanded He condemn her. "The Law says she should be stoned. What do You say?"

And Jesus bent down and wrote in the dust. Then He said:

""He who is without sin among you, let him throw a stone at her first.""

— John 8:7 (NKJV)

One by one, they left. And Jesus — the only Person in that square who had the right to condemn her — said:

""Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more.""

— **John 8:11 (NKJV)**

Two things happened in that moment. First: grace. "Neither do I condemn you." He did not minimize her sin — He covered it with mercy. Second: truth. "Go and sin no more." He did not leave her in the cycle — He empowered her to walk out of it.

This is exactly what God is saying to you right now. Not condemnation. Not "you're hopeless." But: "I do not condemn you. Now rise. Walk in freedom. Sin no more — not because you are strong enough, but because I am."

Practical Steps Toward Freedom:

1. Confess — Break the Secrecy. Addiction thrives in darkness. As long as this remains your secret, it retains its power. Find one trustworthy, mature believer — a pastor, a mentor, a Christian counselor — and bring this into the light. Not to be judged. To be free.

""Confess your trespasses to one another, and pray for one another, that you may be healed.""

— **James 5:16 (NKJV)**

2. Identify Your Triggers. What emotional state precedes your falls? Loneliness? Stress? Boredom? Anger? Write them down. When you know your triggers, you can build hedges before the moment arrives.

3. Remove Access. Install accountability software on your devices. Delete apps. Remove yourself from environments that lead to temptation. This is not legalism — it is wisdom. Jesus said, "If your right eye causes you to sin, pluck it out" (Matthew 5:29). He was speaking in hyperbole to make a point: remove anything that gives the enemy a foothold.

4. Replace the Void. Remember — the underlying need is real. You were created for intimacy, connection, and emotional nourishment. Fill that need with what God designed: prayer, worship, Scripture, deep friendships, and vulnerability in your marriage if you are married.

5. Seek Deliverance. If the spiritual roots are deep, do not be afraid to seek deliverance prayer from a Spirit-filled minister who understands spiritual warfare. Some chains require more than counseling — they require the authority of Christ spoken over your life.

Healing Prayers

A Prayer for Deliverance from Pornography

Father God, I come before You in the name of Jesus Christ with no more hiding. I confess that I have been bound by pornography and lust. I hate this chain, Lord. I have tried to break it in my own strength and I have failed. But Your Word says that whom the Son sets free is free indeed (John 8:36). Set me free today. I renounce every covenant I have made with lust — knowingly or unknowingly. I renounce every image I have allowed into my mind. I plead the blood of Jesus over my eyes, my mind, and my body. Holy Spirit, cleanse the temple. Reset the pathways of my brain. Restore my purity. I receive my freedom now. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for Restoration of Intimacy

Lord, pornography has stolen my ability to connect with real people in real ways. It has distorted my view of intimacy and damaged my closest relationships. I ask You to restore what the enemy has stolen. Heal my marriage. Heal my friendships. Heal my ability to see people as You see them — not as objects, but as Your beloved creation. Teach me what real love looks like. Teach me what real intimacy looks like. Rebuild from the foundation. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer to Break Shame

Father, I have carried shame for so long that it has become part of my identity. I have felt unworthy to worship, unworthy to serve, unworthy to call myself Your child. But Your Word says there is no condemnation for those in Christ Jesus (Romans 8:1). I reject shame. I receive Your grace. I

am not what I did — I am who You say I am: forgiven, cleansed, redeemed, and loved. In Jesus' name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

"I am free from the bondage of pornography. The chain is broken."

"My mind is being renewed. Every corrupt image is being washed by the blood of Jesus."

"I am not my addiction. I am a child of God walking in deliverance."

"The spirit of lust has no authority over me. I belong to Christ."

"My purity is being restored. My eyes belong to the Lord."

"I will walk in transparency, accountability, and truth."

"My marriage and relationships are being healed from the damage of secrecy."

"I choose real intimacy over counterfeit pleasure."

"Shame is evicted from my heart. Grace is my new address."

"Every neural pathway of addiction is being rewired by the power of God."

Reflection & Healing

Reflect on These Questions

1. When did your struggle with pornography begin? What was happening in your life emotionally at that time?
2. What are your primary triggers? (Loneliness, stress, rejection, boredom, late nights?)
3. Is there someone you trust enough to confess this to? If not, ask God to provide that person.

4. How has this struggle affected your relationship with God, your spouse, or your family?

5. What practical steps can you take this week to remove access and build hedges? (Accountability software, schedule changes, device limits?)

6. What void are you trying to fill with pornography? What does God want to fill it with?

Child of God, the shame ends here. Not tomorrow — today. Jesus is not standing over you with condemnation. He is standing beside you with freedom in His hands. Take it. Walk in it. You are not your addiction. You are His.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father God, in the name of Jesus Christ, I come on behalf of every reader who is trapped in the grip of pornography and sexual bondage. Lord, this is not a struggle they can overcome alone — it requires Your supernatural power.

I speak to the chains of lust, addiction, shame, and secrecy: break, in the name of Jesus. I speak to every demonic assignment attached to this bondage: your assignment is cancelled. I plead the blood of Jesus over this reader's mind, eyes, hands, and heart.

Lord, restore their purity. Restore their dignity. Restore their intimacy with You. Give them the courage to seek accountability and the grace to walk in daily freedom. Let this day mark the end of the old cycle and the beginning of a new life. In Jesus' mighty name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never given your life to Jesus Christ, or if addiction has pulled you away from Him, He is reaching out to you now — not with a pointed finger, but with an open hand. Pray: "Lord Jesus, I am broken and I need You. I confess my sin and I receive Your forgiveness. I believe You died for me and rose again. Come into my life and set me free. Be my Lord, my deliverer, and my strength. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit. In Jesus' name, amen."

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PORN HAS HELD ME FROM YOU, GOD

This booklet addresses one of the silent struggles hurting many homes and hearts. It is written for the person who loves God yet feels trapped in a cycle of lust, secrecy, and shame. With compassion, biblical truth, and deliverance-focused prayer, Joshua Matthews points the reader toward purity, healing, and freedom in Christ.

**Shame does not have to be
your final story.**



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